

Question 50 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Apply suitable training methods to design a development program for employees who need both practical job skills and conceptual knowledge.

Answer

When both practice and concepts are needed, a blended design is appropriate rather than a single method.

- 1. Start with TNA:** List practical skills vs conceptual knowledge objectives separately.
- 2. Off-the-job for concepts:** Short lectures, discussion, cases and e-modules to build understanding of principles, standards and 'why'.
- 3. Simulations/role play/vestibule:** Safe practice of procedures before live work.
- 4. On-the-job coaching and job rotation:** Real skill under a trained coach with checklists.
- 5. Action learning project:** Apply concepts to a live departmental problem to bind theory and practice.
- 6. E-learning micro-modules:** For conceptual refreshers that employees can repeat.
- 7. Sequence:** Concept → simulated practice → OJT → review. Reverse sequence (pure OJT first) may entrench errors.
- 8. Evaluation:** Knowledge tests (level 2) plus observed job samples (level 3) so both needs are checked.

***Conclusion.** A blended programme using off-the-job conceptual methods plus OJT and practice methods develops both the head and the hand.*